

Auwa Figure — Rieko's To-Do List

28 August 2026. Every task from `figure.md` and `figure-rieko.md`, in the order to do them. Tick as you go. The why for each one is in the Rieko guide (`documents/Auwa-Figure-Rieko.pdf`) — this page is just the list.

The goal: 30 figures. 15 Natural, 15 Sumi. Drop opens mid-November.

ORDER THESE FIRST — THEY TAKE THE LONGEST

Start this week. Everything else waits on the boxes and the bases.

- ☐ Ask 3 kiribako makers for a sample and a price. 14cm x 14cm x 10-11cm tall. Thick walls. Fitted lid. Single-board lid. Quantity 40. *Search:* 桐箱 オーダーメイド / 桐箱 別注 / 桐箱 製造
 - ☐ Ask 2-3 woodturners for a price. 40 discs, 9cm across, hinoki or keyaki, small chamfer, shallow blind holes for the feet. Send them a figure or the foot measurements. *Search:* 木地師 / 木工 ろくろ / 木製 台座 オーダー
 - ☐ Order one brass stamp of the Auwa mark. For the base, the box lid and the card.
 - ☐ Order the filament: PLA Wood White Oak (13106) x 3kg, PLA Wood Black Walnut (13107) x 1 spool.
 - ☐ Fit a hardened steel nozzle if there isn't one on the printer already.
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DECIDE — BEFORE ANY TESTING

- ☐ **Black Auwa: character or colour?** Decide with the books. This sets the names and the website words.
 - ☐ **Freeze the shape at 10cm.** Pick the date. No changes to the model after it.
 - ☐ **Write down the eyes.** Size, position, colour. Both versions. Decide once, then copy it every time.
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BUY

- ☐ Sandpaper: 180, 320, 400, 600 grit
 - ☐ Small foam sanding blocks
 - ☐ Water-based wood stain, dark or ebony — two or three strengths
 - ☐ Clear matte hard wax (paste wax) + soft cloths
 - ☐ Camellia oil (tsubaki), small bottle — for the test only
 - ☐ Fine paintbrushes for the eyes
 - ☐ Natural undyed wool felt sheet
 - ☐ Undyed cotton or washi for wrapping — enough for 40
 - ☐ Card stock for the hand-written cards — enough for 40
 - ☐ Plain outer cartons and void fill — enough for 40
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SIX TESTS — ONE AT A TIME

Change only one thing per test. Keep every test piece and label it.

- ☐ **1. Layers.** Print the same figure at 0.2mm and at 0.08mm. Sand both. Compare.
 - ☐ **2. Sanding time.** Sand one figure fully and time it with a clock. Write the number down. Order: 180 → 320 → 400 → 600. Foam block on the curves. Hardest spots: under the arms, between the legs, and the mark on the top of the head.
 - ☐ **3. Stain.** Test stain on White Oak and on Black Walnut, several strengths. Aim: near-black, grain still visible.
 - ☐ **4. Finish.** Sand three pieces the same. Leave one bare. Oil one with camellia oil. Wax and buff one. Choose by touch, not by photo.
 - ☐ **5. The number.** Add the edition number to the model, underneath, between the legs. Print it. Check it is clean and readable.
 - ☐ **6. Posting.** Pack one figure exactly as it will be sold. Post it abroad to a friend. Ask them to photograph the opening.
 - ☐ **Weigh a finished figure.** If it feels too light, add steel shot through a hole underneath and glue a cap over it.
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MAKE THE FIRST FIVE

Five finished pieces are enough to open the drop. Tom photographs them.

- ☐ Design the obi band: logo, edition, number, on washi
- ☐ Write one card by hand as the template — your words, Japanese or both
- ☐ Make 3 complete pieces, box included, by early October
- ☐ Tom photographs, mid-October

The two hours, per figure:

1. Print with the number underneath — 10 min
2. Remove supports, clean up — 10 min
3. Sand 180 → 320 → 400 → 600 — 30-45 min
4. Stain (Sumi only), dry fully — 10 min
5. Wax and buff — 10 min
6. Paint the eyes — 8 min
7. Check the number underneath — 3 min
8. Fit to the base — 5 min
9. Sign the base, write the number — 2 min
10. Write the card by hand — 6 min
11. Pack: cloth, felt cradle, base flat underneath, card on top, lid, obi, outer carton — 14 min
12. Record which number went to whom — 4 min

The figure lies down in the box. It never stands.

SAVE FOR LATER — DO NOT DO NOW

- ☐ Paint one figure your way as a test. Put it away. It opens the artist series later, not this edition.
 - ☐ Metal bases. Save them for a collab piece.
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DATES

When	What
Now → mid-September	The three decisions, the six tests, orders placed
Late September	Material, finish and price locked
Early October	Three complete pieces exist, box included

Mid-October	Tom photographs
Mid-November	The drop opens. Made to order over three weeks.

Order 40 of everything, not 30. Breakages, photography, press, and the parcels that go to Japanese makers with the books.